

Digital content management

- Is a growing problem for many users
 - vast numbers of documents, images, music files, video clips, emails, attachments, bookmarks, etc.,
 - where and how to save them all, then remembering what they were called and where to find them again
 - naming most common means of encoding them
 - but can be difficult to remember, especially when have 1000s and 1000s
 - How might such a process be facilitated taking into account people's memory abilities?

Digital content management

- Memory involves 2 processes
 - recall-directed and recognition-based scanning
- File management systems should be designed to optimize both kinds of memory processes
 - e.g. Search box and history list
- Help users encode files in richer ways
 - Provide them with ways of saving files using colour, flagging, image, flexible text, time stamping, etc.

Is Apple's Spotlight search tool any good?

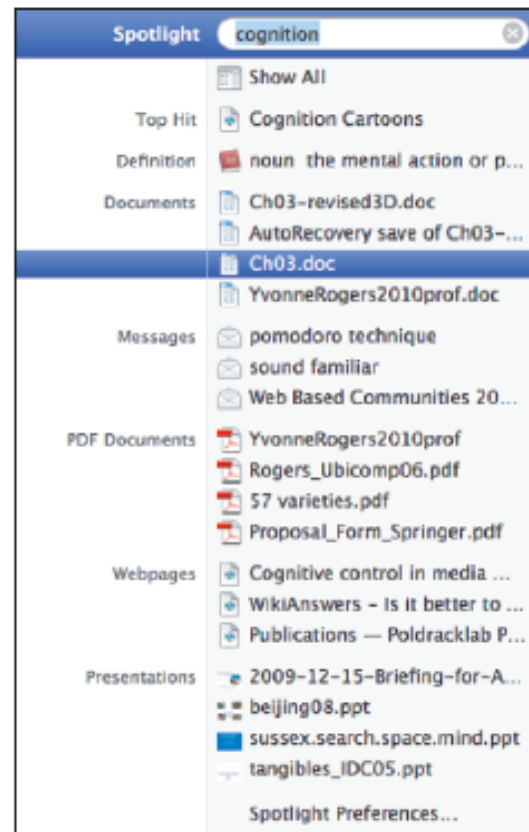


Figure 3.3 Apple's Spotlight search tool

Digital Forgetting

- When might you wish to forget something that is online?
 - When you break up with a partner
 - Emotionally painful to be reminded of them through shared photos, social media, etc.
- Sas and Whittaker (2013) suggest new ways of harvesting and deleting digital content
 - e.g. making photos of ex into an abstract collage
 - helps with closure

Memory aids

- SenseCam developed by Microsoft Research Labs (now Autographer)
- a wearable device that intermittently takes photos without any user intervention while worn
- digital images taken are stored and revisited using special software
- Has been found to improve people's memory, suffering from Alzheimers

SenseCam



Figure 3.5 The SenseCam device and a digital image taken with it

Source: ©Microsoft Research Cambridge.

Design implications

- Don't overload users' memories with complicated procedures for carrying out tasks
- Design interfaces that promote recognition rather than recall
- Provide users with various ways of encoding information to help them remember
 - e.g. categories, color, flagging, time stamping